

BOUNDARIES

(BROWN DENOTES INSTRUCTIONS TO TECHNICIAN)
(BLUE DENOTES POWER POINT SLIDE)

TEXT: Proverbs 22:28 (NKJV) “Do not remove the ancient landmark
Which your fathers have set.”

Proverbs 23:10-11 (NKJV) “Do not remove the ancient landmark, Nor
enter the fields of the fatherless; ¹¹ For their Redeemer is mighty; He will
plead their cause against you.”

Hosea 5:10 (NKJV) “*The princes of Judah are like those who remove a*
landmark; I will pour out my wrath on them like water.”

INTRO: Today we are going to begin a study of boundaries. The current culture seems to be reeling out of control, driven in large part by a lack of boundaries. Boundaries have received a bad name in contemporary America as a, “*If it feels good, do it*” mentality overpowers all that is good, right, and virtuous. Edgy living is in vogue while virtuous living is ridiculed. What in the world is wrong with America? Better yet, what is wrong with the church?

If there is not repentance and revival, a lack of social and Biblical boundaries will eventually destroy the fabric of the American family and will ultimately destroy this once great country. The most discouraging thing about what we are facing as a nation is that it seems that many ministers who should be speaking out against the misdeeds of a culture out of control, are actually: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- At the best, accepting of it...
- Ignoring it in hopes it will get better...
- At the worst, challenging Christians to become like the culture...

What is the responsibility of the church and a minister in a culture where right seems wrong and wrong seems right? Ezekiel 3: 17-21 (NKJV) “*Son of man, I have made you a watchman for the house of Israel; therefore hear a word from My mouth, and give them warning from Me: ¹⁸“When I say to the wicked, ‘You shall surely die,’ and you give him no warning, nor*

speaking to warn the wicked from his wicked way, to save his life, that same wicked man shall die in his iniquity; but his blood I will require at your hand. ¹⁹“Yet, if you warn the wicked, and he does not turn from his wickedness, nor from his wicked way, he shall die in his iniquity; but you have delivered your soul. ²⁰“Again, when a righteous man turns from his righteousness and commits iniquity, and I lay a stumbling block before him, he shall die; because you did not give him warning, he shall die in his sin, and his righteousness which he has done shall not be remembered; but his blood I will require at your hand. ²¹“Nevertheless if you warn the righteous man that the righteous should not sin, and he does not sin, he shall surely live because he took warning; also you will have delivered your soul.” Isaiah 58:1 (NKJV) “Cry aloud, spare not; Lift up your voice like a trumpet; Tell My people their transgression, And the house of Jacob their sins.”

It is my belief that the church and the professional clergy must bear a tremendous part of the responsibility for the ills of the current culture! As goes the church, so goes the world! The problem with the culture is that preachers are not preaching against sin and drawing the moral line in the sand, therefore, the culture has lost its moral compass! When the moral lines get cluttered or erased at the church, what can you expect in the world? 1 Peter 4:17-18 (NKJV) “The time has come for judgment to begin at the house of God; and if it begins with us first, what will be the end of those who do not obey the gospel of God? ¹⁸ Now “If the righteous one is scarcely saved, Where will the ungodly and the sinner appear?”

Based on the Scriptures I just read, I want to take a few Sundays to dutifully discharge my responsibility as a Pastor. As a man of God I am here to tell you that boundaries are a good thing: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- In a relationship...
- In a home...
- In the workplace...
- In the church...
- In the culture...

Boundaries are very useful: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- On the highway... (The median – The centerline)
- In the air... (Flight paths)
- On the seas... (Shipping lanes)
- On paper... (Margins)
- With regard to property rights... (Fences)

Proverbs 22:28 (NKJV) ***“Do not remove the ancient landmark Which your fathers have set.”*** The writer here is quoting the instructions of Moses to the Children of Israel for the time when they would enter the Promised Land. He is telling them their property should be marked by boundaries and that they were not to uproot the boundaries because it would lead to:

- Disputes...
- Arguments...
- Disagreements
- Lawlessness...

The commandments regarding the necessity of boundaries, was intended to aid the Children of Israel in being able to peaceably occupy Canaan. What kind of boundaries has God set for us, so we can live peaceably in this present world? 2 Corinthians 6:14-18 (NKJV) ***“Do not be unequally yoked together with unbelievers. For what fellowship has righteousness with lawlessness? And what communion has light with darkness? ¹⁵And what accord has Christ with Belial? Or what part has a believer with an unbeliever? ¹⁶And what agreement has the temple of God with idols? For you are the temple of the living God. As God has said: “I will dwell in them And walk among them. I will be their God, And they shall be My people.” ¹⁷Therefore “Come out from among them And be separate, says the Lord. Do not touch what is unclean, And I will receive you.” ¹⁸“I will be a Father to you, And you shall be My sons and daughters, Says the LORD Almighty.”***

Gods Word is full of boundaries that each of us would do well to live by. When God sets a boundary it is never for the purpose of being a party-pooper, it is to provide a path to peace and prosperity.

Look at the Ten Commandments: (Exodus 20) **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Thou shalt have no other gods before me...
- Thou shalt not make unto thee any graven image...
- Thou shalt not take the name of the LORD thy God in vain...
- Remember the Sabbath day, to keep it holy...
- Honor thy father and thy mother...
- Thou shalt not kill...
- Thou shalt not commit adultery...
- Thou shalt not steal...
- Thou shalt not bear false witness against thy neighbor...
- Thou shalt not covet...

God only gave us ten rules; one would think we could live within the perimeters of just ten rules! The Ten Commandments were given to us by God for the purpose of establishing boundaries in our lives! The boundaries God attempted to establish in our lives were not for His entertainment, they are for our good!

As an earthly father I have never denied my children the opportunity to do anything with the goal of keeping them from experiencing life at its best, my reason for saying no and establishing boundaries is always for the purpose of enhancing their life over the long haul. Listen to what Jesus had to say on this very subject, Matthew 7:9-11 (NKJV) ***“What man is there among you who, if his son asks for bread, will give him a stone? ¹⁰“Or if he asks for a fish, will he give him a serpent? ¹¹“If you then, being evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your Father who is in heaven give good things to those who ask Him!”***

I do not feel particularly led to do a series on the Ten Commandments but over the next few weeks we are going to take on some of the biggest, most controversial challenges this culture faces. We are going to address what I consider to be the three greatest enemies facing America and the American

Church Today: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Alcohol...
- Abortion...
- Homosexuality...

I. THE CHRISTIAN AND ALCOHOL

I realize the subject I am dealing with today is controversial in Christian circles and will likely be controversial in this setting as well. All I ask is for each of you to hear me out with an open mind and search the scriptures I am going to share with you, as well as the line of reasoning I will follow.

Traditionally, the stance of the protestant church in America has been that of total abstinence. In recent years many have come to question our stance, and when we did not furnish a satisfactory answer to why we take that stand, they assume there is no good reason to abide by these traditional values.

Allow me to begin by saying that **I believe total abstinence is the boundary a Christian should set with regard to alcohol consumption. (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)**

Those who believe we should soften, readjust, or erase this very important boundary, will almost always say, “*The Word of God is not clear on where the boundary should be set.*” I must admit, even though my personal stand as well as my theological stand has always been total abstinence, I was a bit intimidated to join the discussion because I had never really studied this subject in depth. That has changed; I have conducted a thorough study of the subject which has spanned several months and I am going to attempt to share the results of my research with you over the next couple of Sundays. My study will cover the theological position as well as the cultural effects of this issue.

Let’s **look at what the Scripture has to say concerning alcohol consumption:** (I will be having you to turn to and mark each Scriptural reference) **PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME BUT DO NOT REMOVE ANY UNTIL THE LIST IS COMPLETE)**

- The Lord speaks to Moses concerning the vow of a Nazarite... Numbers 6:1-4 (KJV) “*And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying, ²Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, When either man or woman shall separate themselves to vow a vow of a Nazarite, to separate themselves unto the LORD: ³He shall separate himself from wine and strong drink, and shall drink no vinegar of wine, or vinegar of strong drink, neither shall he drink any liquor of grapes, nor eat moist grapes, or dried. ⁴All the days of his separation shall he eat nothing that is made of the vine tree, from the kernels even to the husk.*” The vow of the Nazarite was

constructed to make sure the individual being separated as a Nazarite would be an example to all Israelites of the highest standard of holiness in their commitment to God as well as their lifestyle. According to God's clear instructions, a Nazarite was to abstain completely from ***"wine and strong drink."*** The warning was so strong that the Nazarite was instructed not to consume any product made from the grape or grapevine either in liquid or solid form. Most likely God gave this command as a safeguard against the temptation to use intoxicating drinks and against the possibility of a Nazarite drinking alcoholic wine by mistake. God did not want any totally devoted person to be exposed to the possibility of intoxication or addiction, even unknowingly. If God was so strict with the Nazarite that they could not even touch any product derived from the vine, then His highest call to the believer is that of total abstinence. Complete consecration to God and His standards of holiness is something Christians should emulate on a free will basis. Every believer should avoid anything which has the potential of drawing us into sin; stimulating a desire for harmful things; place us in a compromising position; dull our decision making ability; cause a brother or sister to stumble; or open the door to drug or alcohol addiction.

- [The Lord speaks to the Children of Israel...](#) and say's in [Deuteronomy 29:5-6](#) (KJV) ***"I have led you forty years in the wilderness: your clothes are not waxen old upon you, and thy shoe is not waxen old upon thy foot. ⁶Ye have not eaten bread, neither have ye drunk wine or strong drink: that ye might know that I am the LORD your God."***
- [Solomon, the wisest man ever addresses our subject...](#) [Proverbs 20:1](#) (KJV) ***"Wine is a mocker, strong drink is raging: and whosoever is deceived thereby is not wise."***
- [Solomon speaks out again on this topic...](#) [Proverbs 23:29-35](#) (KJV) ***"Who hath woe? who hath sorrow? who hath contentions? Who hath babbling? who hath wounds without cause? who hath redness of eyes? ³⁰ They that tarry long at the wine; they that go to seek mixed wine. ³¹ Look not thou upon the wine when it is red, when it giveth his colour in the cup, when it moveth itself aright."*** These verses contain clear instruction regarding abstinence from alcoholic drink. The Hebrew verb used for the phrase ***"When it is red"*** is *"yith'addam"* literally means *"When it is made red"* and directly points to the color of fermented wine. ***"³²At the last it biteth like a serpent, and stingeth like an adder."*** This passage describes the addictive effects of fermented wine. Alcohol can be demonic and destructive, resulting in physical ailments, blurred vision, lack of judgment, a confused

mind, and a loose tongue. Consuming even one alcoholic drink leads to some impairment of a person's motor skills and ability to make sound judgments. Continued use opens one's life to intoxication and addiction with all their harmful consequences physically, socially, spiritually and morally. The only way to be sure one will not end up this way is to avoid all intoxicating beverages. ***³⁴Thine eyes shall behold strange women, and thine heart shall utter perverse things. ³⁴Yea, thou shalt be as he that lieth down in the midst of the sea, or as he that lieth upon the top of a mast. ³⁵They have stricken me, shalt thou say, and I was not sick; they have beaten me, and I felt it not: when shall I awake? I will seek it yet again."***

- Solomon's Mother weighs in on the subject... Proverbs 31:4-6 (KJV) ***"It is not for kings, O Lemuel, it is not for kings to drink wine; nor for princes strong drink: ⁵Lest they drink, and forget the law, and pervert the judgment of any of the afflicted. ⁶Give strong drink unto him that is ready to perish, and wine unto those that be of heavy hearts. ⁷Let him drink, and forget his poverty, and remember his misery no more."***
- The prophet Isaiah speaks rather clearly and at length about the effects of this dangerous substance... Isaiah 5:11:15 (KJV) ***"Woe unto them that rise up early in the morning, that they may follow strong drink; that continue until night, till wine inflame them! ¹²And the harp, and the viol, the tabret, and pipe, and wine, are in their feasts: but they regard not the work of the LORD, neither consider the operation of his hands. ¹³Therefore my people are gone into captivity, because they have no knowledge: and their honourable men are famished, and their multitude dried up with thirst. ¹⁴Therefore hell hath enlarged herself, and opened her mouth without measure: and their glory, and their multitude, and their pomp, and he that rejoiceth, shall descend into it. ¹⁵And the mean man shall be brought down, and the mighty man shall be humbled, and the eyes of the lofty shall be humbled."*** Isaiah 24:5-12 (KJV) ***"The earth also is defiled under the inhabitants thereof; because they have transgressed the laws, changed the ordinance, broken the everlasting covenant. ⁶Therefore hath the curse devoured the earth, and they that dwell therein are desolate: therefore the inhabitants of the earth are burned, and few men left. ⁷The new wine mourneth, the vine languisheth, all the merryhearted do sigh. ⁸The mirth of tabrets ceaseth, the noise of them that rejoice endeth, the joy of the harp ceaseth. ⁹They shall not drink wine with a song; strong drink shall be bitter to them that drink it. ¹⁰The city of confusion is broken down: every house is shut up, that no man may come in. ¹¹There is a crying for wine in***

the streets; all joy is darkened, the mirth of the land is gone. ¹²In the city is left desolation, and the gate is smitten with destruction.” [Isaiah 28:1-8](#) (KJV) *“Woe to the crown of pride, to the drunkards of Ephraim, whose glorious beauty is a fading flower, which are on the head of the fat valleys of them that are overcome with wine! ²Behold, the Lord hath a mighty and strong one, which as a tempest of hail and a destroying storm, as a flood of mighty waters overflowing, shall cast down to the earth with the hand. ³The crown of pride, the drunkards of Ephraim, shall be trodden under feet: ⁴And the glorious beauty, which is on the head of the fat valley, shall be a fading flower, and as the hasty fruit before the summer; which when he that looketh upon it seeth, while it is yet in his hand he eateth it up. ⁵In that day shall the LORD of hosts be for a crown of glory, and for a diadem of beauty, unto the residue of his people, ⁶And for a spirit of judgment to him that sitteth in judgment, and for strength to them that turn the battle to the gate. ⁷But they also have erred through wine, and through strong drink are out of the way; the priest and the prophet have erred through strong drink, they are swallowed up of wine, they are out of the way through strong drink; they err in vision, they stumble in judgment. ⁸For all tables are full of vomit and filthiness, so that there is no place clean.”* [Isaiah 56:10-12](#) (KJV) *“His watchmen are blind: they are all ignorant, they are all dumb dogs, they cannot bark; sleeping, lying down, loving to slumber. ¹¹Yea, they are greedy dogs which can never have enough, and they are shepherds that cannot understand: they all look to their own way, every one for his gain, from his quarter. ¹²Come ye, say they, I will fetch wine, and we will fill ourselves with strong drink; and to morrow shall be as this day, and much more abundant.”* William Shakespeare said, “O God, that men should put an enemy in their mouths to steal away their brains! That we should with joy, pleasance, revel, and applause, transform ourselves into beasts!”

- [Paul enlightens the Romans with regard to the subject of alcohol consumption...](#) [Romans 14:20-23](#) (NKJV) *“Do not destroy the work of God for the sake of food. All things indeed are pure, but it is evil for the man who eats with offense. ²¹It is good neither to eat meat nor drink wine nor do anything by which your brother stumbles or is offended or is made weak. ²²Do you have faith? Have it to yourself before God. Happy is he who does not condemn himself in what he approves. ²³But he who doubts is condemned if he eats, because he does not eat from faith; for whatever is not from faith is sin.”*

- Paul warns his understudy, Timothy, about the evils of alcohol... 1 Timothy 3:2-10 (NKJV) *“A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, temperate, sober-minded, of good behavior, hospitable, able to teach; ³not given to wine, not violent, not greedy for money, but gentle, not quarrelsome, not covetous; ⁴one who rules his own house well, having his children in submission with all reverence ⁵(for if a man does not know how to rule his own house, how will he take care of the church of God?); ⁶not a novice, lest being puffed up with pride he fall into the same condemnation as the devil. ⁷Moreover he must have a good testimony among those who are outside, lest he fall into reproach and the snare of the devil.⁸Likewise deacons must be reverent, not double-tongued, not given to much wine, not greedy for money, ⁹holding the mystery of the faith with a pure conscience. ¹⁰But let these also first be tested; then let them serve as deacons, being found blameless.”* Paul said the same thing to Titus in [Titus 1:8](#) that he said to Timothy here, *“Not given to wine.”* Then when he is speaking to Titus with regard to the women in the church ([Titus 2:3](#)) he uses the phrase *“Not given to much wine.”*
- Paul, talking to Timothy as well as some other church leaders makes this alarming statement... in 1 Timothy 5:23 (NKJV) *“No longer drink only water, but use a little wine for your stomach’s sake and your frequent infirmities.”* Some well-meaning people have misused the instruction given by Paul to Timothy; he was not suggesting that Timothy begin drinking socially or responsibly! As a result of some illnesses Timothy was obviously struggling with, Paul suggest he consider wine only for medicinal purposes. After studying this at great length I am quite sure the wine Paul is referring to here was unfermented. It is generally believed that Timothy normally did not drink wine of any kind, fermented or unfermented, which is why Paul gives him special permission to do so for medicinal purposes. According to Greek writings on medicine, wine used for the “stomachs sake” was more than likely unfermented and thus not intoxicating. Athenaeus states, *“Let him take sweet wine, either mixed with water or warmed, especially that kind called protropos (juice coming from the grapes before they are pressed), as being good for the stomach, for sweet wine (oinos) does not make the head heavy.”* (Athenaeus, Banquet, 2:24) Based on significant research of ancient Greek writers I think is unlikely that Paul was condoning the moderate or responsible use of intoxicating wine for medicinal purposes for Timothy and church leaders. In my opinion, it is far more likely that Paul was advising the use of unfermented wine for health reasons. One must understand that one of the few beverages available in

Bible times was grape juice or fermented wine. It is almost certain that the first century Apostles practiced total abstinence with regard to the fruit of the vine, whether fermented or unfermented. Paul knew that if the ministers began the practice of using unfermented wine it could very easily serve as a gateway to thinking the consumption of fermented wine was an acceptable practice for ministerial and church leaders. Therefore he says to Timothy, ***“Use a little wine for the stomach’s sake.”*** While I do not believe Paul was giving Timothy, or anyone else permission to use fermented wine for medicinal purposes, let’s just say for the sake of argument that he was. There is quite a difference between taking cough medicine, which contains alcohol and drinking socially or responsibly because one wants to drink alcohol! In Timothy’s culture medicine and doctors were not what they are today. In this culture I see no real benefit for one to consume wine or alcohol for medicinal purposes, or for any other reason! Some people say they are doing it for health purposes, when the fact is, studies have shown that a glass of pure grape juice will do medicinally, what a glass of wine will! The fact that Paul had to mention the medicinal use of wine indicates rather strongly that Timothy was committed to abstinence as a lifestyle.

The Word of God records several tragic events which can be tied directly to alcohol consumption: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- **Noah...** Noah saved his family from a flood that destroyed the world! If that were the end of the story, it would be a tremendous testimony! As Paul Harvey used to say, *“The rest of the story”* is not so terrific! While under the influence of alcohol Noah embarrassed himself by exposing himself to his sons. He not only brought a reproach upon himself, he embarrassed his entire family and sinned against God! The results of Noah’s actions were disastrous! ([Genesis 9:20-27](#)). I submit to you that if Noah had not consumed alcohol he would never have had such an ominous mark on his character! Take the alcohol out of this scenario and you have a true hero! Include the stimulus of alcohol and you have a one time hero, gone bad! Why run the risk?
- **Lot...** Lot was a guy who already had enough problems without introducing alcohol into his family situation. His wife was so intoxicated with the lifestyle of the sodomites that she could not resist disobeying a direct command from God; she discovered that she was turning into a salt block while looking back to an extraordinarily sinful city! She wanted to return to Sodom, but she woke up dead instead! Following his wife’s untimely death, Lot was left to raise two daughters as a single father. His daughters served

him liquor until he became drunk; once intoxicated, Lot parts with all reason and sensibility, and commits incest with his daughters! ([Genesis 19:30-38](#)). Bertrand Russell said, *“Drunkenness is temporary suicide.”*

- [Xerxes...](#) This powerful King ruled over a great kingdom and had a beautiful wife. Though he was intelligent enough to lead a Kingdom successfully, once intoxicated, he could not hold his liquor nor his own marriage together! Xerxes allowed his mouth to override his sense of reason, all because of the effects of alcohol. While under the influence, he commanded his wife to do things she was not willing to do, and when she refused, in order to keep the other ladies in the Kingdom from rebelling against their husbands, it became necessary for Xerxes to depose the queen and find another. ([Esther 1:9-22](#)) This was not the first, nor the last marriage to be ended because of the evils of alcohol!
- [Belshazzar...](#) While in a drunken stupor, this otherwise intellectually brilliant King committed sacrilege with the sacred vessels from the Jewish temple. The judgment of God was swift and stern! That very night he was killed as a fulfillment of prophecy ([Daniel 5](#)). If God would kill a man for drinking alcohol out of the consecrated vessels from the Old Testament Temple, what do you think His opinion of placing the same thing in a vessel which is a *“Temple of the Holy Ghost”* would be?

(PLAY VIDEO OF POLICE CHIEF, OFFICER ROBERT HUACK OF TOMBALL TEXAS)

(END OF SERMON #1)

[Proverbs 22:28](#) (NKJV) *“Do not remove the ancient landmark Which your fathers have set.”*

[Proverbs 23:10-11](#) (NKJV) *“Do not remove the ancient landmark, Nor enter the fields of the fatherless; ¹¹ For their Redeemer is mighty; He will plead their cause against you.”*

[Hosea 5:10](#) (NKJV) *“The princes of Judah are like those who remove a landmark; I will pour out my wrath on them like water.”*

In the Old Testament the Tabernacle or Temple was a physical building. [Under grace the abiding place of God is in human beings rather than a physical building.](#)

(LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE) 1 Corinthians 6:19-20 (KJV)

“Know ye not that your body is the temple of the Holy Ghost which is in you, which ye have of God, and ye are not your own? ²⁰For ye are bought with a price: therefore glorify God in your body, and in your spirit, which are God’s.”

Look at what the Angel said to Zacharias at the announcement of the birth of John the Baptist. **Luke 1:15-16 (NKJV)** ***“For he will be great in the sight of the Lord, and shall drink neither wine nor strong drink. He will also be filled with the Holy Spirit, even from his mother’s womb. ¹⁶“And he will turn many of the children of Israel to the Lord their God.”***

In the Old Testament the Levites who were the spiritual leaders of the people were instructed to maintain a position of total abstinence from wine or intoxicating drink. **Leviticus 10:8-11: (NKJV)** ***“Then the LORD spoke to Aaron, saying: Do not drink wine or intoxicating drink ⁹“, you, nor your sons with you, when you go into the tabernacle of meeting, lest you die. It shall be a statute forever throughout your generations, ¹⁰“that you may distinguish between holy and unholy, and between unclean and clean, ¹¹“and that you may teach the children of Israel all the statutes which the LORD has spoken to them by the hand of Moses.”*** This requirement of abstinence was given so the judgment of the ministering priest would not be impaired by outside influences. The Lord wanted the priests to be at their best while ministering to and for the people.

Under the dispensation of grace all born-again believers are Kings and Priests unto God. **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE) 1 Peter 2:9 (NKJV)** ***“But you are a chosen generation, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, His own special people, that you may proclaim the praises of Him who called you out of darkness into His marvelous light; ¹⁰who once were not a people but are now the people of God, who had not obtained mercy but now have obtained mercy.”***
Revelation 1:5-6 (NKJV) ***“To Him who loved us and washed us from our sins in His own blood, and has made us kings and priests to His God and Father, to Him be glory and dominion forever and ever. Amen.”***

If our bodies are the temple of the Holy Ghost and we are all functioning as Kings and Priests should we not be careful about intentionally allowing outside influences to impair our judgment?

It should go without saying that the standard of abstinence demanded of the Old Testament Priest should be the standard of every contemporary Christian. **The Christian community has a breathtaking responsibility to lead its culture to Christ,**

(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE) and indulging in something that is wreaking havoc on the society we are attempting to win, hardly seems plausible. As believers, we have a responsibility to do all we can to set a Godly example and display righteous conduct. I hardly think alcohol consumption comes close to a Godly example or righteous conduct.

For all of those who would say that believers are not the Priests but the vocational ministers are the Priests; let me remind you that the Word of God speaks out against the use of alcohol among civic leaders! **Proverbs 31:4-5** (KJV) ***"It is not for kings, O Lemuel, it is not for kings to drink wine; nor for princes strong drink: ⁵Lest they drink, and forget the law, and pervert the judgment of any of the afflicted."*** If those who are leading the secular world have a responsibility to stay away from such an impairing substance it should follow that Christians are held to a higher standard than those who are not Christians.

How much alcohol is too much? **Proverbs 23:29-32** **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)** (KJV) ***"Who hath woe? who hath sorrow? who hath contentions? Who hath babbling? who hath wounds without cause? who hath redness of eyes? ³⁰They that tarry long at the wine; they that go to seek mixed wine. ³¹Look not thou upon the wine when it is red, when it giveth his colour in the cup, when it moveth itself aright. ³²At the last it biteth like a serpent, and stingeth like an adder."*** By medical definition, alcohol is a drug! If a little alcohol consumption is alright where is the line? Is the line the same for everyone? By rejecting the stance of total abstinence are we opening the door of destruction to those who cannot handle it? Are we placing people who are predisposed to alcohol abuse in a vulnerable position by needlessly setting the example of responsible alcohol consumption? Is it worth the risk? **Mark Twain** said, *"Sometimes too much drink is barely enough."*

Without question there have been too many heated arguments on this subject and it is not my intention to start another one, it is my intention to tell you everything I know and let you make your own decision.

I want to present one more Scriptural angle on this subject by asking and answering **three basic questions: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- When the Bible mentions **"wine"** is it always referring to an alcoholic drink as it is in our culture? Many Bible scholars and theologians agree that there were many different kinds of wine in the Bible; some believe there may have

been as many as 150 varieties of wine. I know this, the Hebrew language has nine different words which are translated wine in the Old Testament and the Greek employs four different words, which are merged into one word in the King James Version of the New Testament. Some people take an extreme position and say that what the Bible is speaking of is never alcoholic in content. That is absurd and cannot be successfully defended by Scripture or history! Another indefensible view is that all wine mentioned in the Bible was alcoholic. Bible scholars tell us that when strong drink or wine is mentioned in the Bible that in some cases it is speaking of a fermented beverage; at other times when wine is mentioned it is either unfermented or mixed in such a diluted form that it would be impossible to get drunk no matter how much one consumed, as the body would get rid of it more quickly than one could drink it. Those who hold to the view of all wine in the Bible being non alcoholic do so without regard to theology or history. Those who believe all wine in the Bible was alcoholic assume that since refrigeration was unavailable in the warm Mediterranean climate, there was no way of preserving the fruit of the vine in an unfermented state. This view ignores evidence from ancient writers such as Pliny (Natural History 14.11) and Columella (De re rustica 12.29) who describe the production of non-alcoholic wine known as *aigloukos* (I-glukos) which means always sweet. The practice for preserving wine in a non-alcoholic state for long periods of time was to boil the fresh grape juice down to about a third of its original volume. The result would be that the condensed juice would then become very sweet, and because of its high sugar content, it both resisted spoilage and did not easily ferment. Later, water could be added back to produce reconstituted juice. In its condensed form, the juice could be used as a sweetener both in cooking and in the production of other wines. Unfermented juice was also used as a medicine. The process which I have just mentioned could be taken a little farther and the juice could be boiled down a little more and the grape juice could then be made into syrups and jellies. The juice, in its condensed form, could also be used as preservatives. Fresh fruit such as pears, for instance, were often packed in grape syrup or in honey to keep them from spoiling (see Columella, De re rustica 12.10 and Cato, De agricultura7).

- [How does the alcoholic content in ancient fermented wine compare with that of the various wines today?](#) In the Bible, sweet wines were generally non-alcoholic, and were hugely popular in the ancient world, since there were not many options beyond water. Because fermentation automatically, chemically, reduces the natural sugars found in grape juice to alcohol; alcoholic wines contain less sugar than unfermented grape juice; thus it is

believed that most “*sweet wine*” or “*best wine*” mentioned in the Bible were non-alcoholic in composition. As already stated the most common method of developing sweet wine was to boil juice down and then later add water to reconstitute it. This practice accounts for many, if not all, of the references to “*mixed wine*” in ancient writing. At other times, water was added in order to dilute fermented wine. This was probably done to reduce its percentage of alcohol or simply to make it go further. Sometimes spices, perfumes and resins were added to wine to change and enhance its flavor. The typical concoction for mixing wine in order to dilute its alcoholic content; change its flavor; or make it go further was three parts water to one part wine. A three-to-one ratio is explicitly mentioned in both Hesiod (Works and days 596) and the Talmud (b. Pesachim 108b). Sometimes in the ancient world, as in modern times, alcoholic wine was consumed in order to become intoxicated. As a rule of thumb, wine was used as an ordinary beverage, not as an intoxicant, and was diluted with water. In our culture, a typical fermented wine has an alcoholic content of about 14 percent which is the point at which the alcohol kills off the yeast and terminates fermentation. Alcoholic wine, mixed at a three-to-one ratio, results in a beverage with a 3.5 percent alcoholic content, which is only mildly intoxicating and then only if a large quantity is consumed. Most people who consume wine or alcohol are not even mildly interested in a drink with a 3.5 percent alcoholic content. This means that inebriation is a much greater problem for wine drinkers today than it was in the ancient world.

- When Jesus turned water into wine at the wedding in Cana of Galilee, was the wine alcoholic or unfermented? John 2:1-10 (NKJV) *“On the third day there was a wedding in Cana of Galilee, and the mother of Jesus was there. ²Now both Jesus and His disciples were invited to the wedding. ³And when they ran out of wine, the mother of Jesus said to Him, “They have no wine.” ⁴Jesus said to her, “**Woman, what does your concern have to do with Me? My hour has not yet come.**” ⁵His mother said to the servants, “Whatever He says to you, do it.” ⁶Now there were set there six waterpots of stone, according to the manner of purification of the Jews, containing twenty or thirty gallons apiece. ⁷Jesus said to them, “**Fill the waterpots with water.**” And they filled them up to the brim. ⁸And He said to them, “**Draw some out now, and take it to the master of the feast.**” And they took it. ⁹When the master of the feast had tasted the water that was made wine, and did not know where it came from (but the servants who had drawn the water knew), the master of the feast called the bridegroom. ¹⁰And he said*

to him, “Every man at the beginning sets out the good wine, and when the guests have well drunk, then the inferior. You have kept the best wine until now!” (Minister who attempted to convince the police officer the wine he was drinking was really water) I have always had a difficult time believing Jesus would turn water into an alcoholic beverage, which carries with it the potential of all kinds of addictions and destruction. He came to build people up, not tear them down! Most Bible Theologians would agree that in Bible times the terms “*good wine*” and “*best wine*” always refer to unfermented wine. The best wine was considered to be the wine which actually tasted the best and was fresh, unfermented juice straight from the grape press. In the King James Version as well as most other versions of the Bible the term “*wine*” is used in a very broad sense, in fact this word is used to identify both fermented and unfermented wine. So when we read our Bible and the Scripture say’s certain people drank wine, it is an inappropriate assumption to automatically presuppose they were drinking fermented wine which contained alcoholic content; it is an equally erroneous assumption to presume they were drinking unfermented wine. In order to properly ascertain which variety of wine is being used, one must do a word study and consider the entire context of Scripture in which the event is set. In order to come to a correct understanding of whether Jesus turned the water into fermented or unfermented wine one must properly understand the person and ministry of Jesus. Through His life and ministry something brand new and unprecedented was about to spring forth on the civil and spiritual canvas. While a new system of religion was imminent, the old order of Judaism was postured to reject anything new which appeared on the horizon. The six stone water jars used for Jewish ceremonial washing represent the old way of Judaism; the new wine that came forth out of the old represents the newness which would characterize the life; ministry; and the new system of religion which Jesus would establish. Jesus turned between 120 and 180 gallons of water into wine! The fact that He performed such a miracle in such a great quantity denotes the extravagant plenteousness and lavish abundance of God’s grace to us through Jesus. It is within this context of newness in the book of John that we consider the question about the kind of wine Jesus created. Was it fermented or unfermented? Was it new wine or aged wine? *It is believed that Jesus created unfermented wine rather than alcoholic wine for the following reasons: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)*

1. *Unfermented wine fits better the context of John with its emphasis on the newness of life and the newness of the gospel. Old wineskins and old wine*

are associated with Judaism, not the gospel. The ultimate goal of redemption is to make all things new.

2. The quality of the wine which Jesus created is called **“good”** (Greek, kalon) **wine”** in contrast to **“the inferior wine.”** (v. 10). According to an assortment of ancient writers, the use of the words **“good wine”** means choice or best wine. In the setting of that culture the terminology which was employed was immediately recognizable as the sweetest wine, or unfermented wine. It is rather obvious in this Scripture that the wine which Jesus created had not had its sugar content destroyed through the process known as fermentation. According to historical terminology, the **“inferior wine”** was alcoholic wine. Unlike the present culture, in antiquity, wine was not thought to improve with age. This is because there was always the danger of the wine souring, or turning to vinegar which is known in history as *“sour wine.”* The banquet master implies the traditional method would be to serve the **“best wine”** (Unfermented) first, and the **“inferior wine”** (Fermented) last. This man is saying, *“We served the best wine we had first and followed it with the inferior wine, but what you have provided is far better than our best wine!”* There is strong Scriptural evidence that Jesus turned the 180 gallons of water at the wedding in Cana of Galilee to unfermented wine.

Let’s just say for the sake of argument that drinking in moderation is not a sin. With all the risks pointed out in the Word of God and all the risks being warned of in our society, are we really willing to take the risk of departing from the stance of total abstinence?

Better yet, what if we can handle it but our children grow up believing there is nothing wrong with it, and they cannot handle it? Can we live with the knowledge that it was our lax stance on the issue that opened the door of destruction in their life? This truth is especially significant when it is applied to the young people of the world who are turning to alcohol in unprecedented numbers as an acceptable mind-altering drug. They are going beyond moderation, no matter what their parents and elders say. If Christian parents and adults use alcohol even in moderation, just to be socially accepted, I can promise you the next generation will use it with less care and self-control. Mark Twain said, *“Water, taken in moderation, cannot hurt anybody.”*

The use of alcohol violates some basic principles laid down for all believers, whether ministers or laymen. One of these important principles is the Biblical

caution not to offend a weaker brother or cause a younger Christian to fall. The best example our generation can set for the next generation is to practice and teach total abstinence. Jesus spoke very clearly to the disciples about the responsibility of the older generation to its children and youth. [Luke 17:1-2](#) (NKJV) ***“Then He said to the disciples, “It is impossible that no offenses should come, but woe to him through whom they do come!” ²“It would be better for him if a millstone were hung around his neck, and he were thrown into the sea, than that he should offend one of these little ones.”*** We must not set an example that will send others to hell and destruction.

In conclusion I want us to go back and reconsider one Scripture. [Proverbs 23:29-35](#) (KJV) ***“Who hath woe? who hath sorrow? who hath contentions? Who hath babbling? who hath wounds without cause? who hath redness of eyes? ³⁰ They that tarry long at the wine; they that go to seek mixed wine. ³¹ Look not thou upon the wine when it is red, when it giveth his colour in the cup, when it moveth itself aright. ³² At the last it biteth like a serpent, and stingeth like an adder. ³³ Thine eyes shall behold strange women, and thine heart shall utter perverse things. ³⁴ Yea, thou shalt be as he that lieth down in the midst of the sea, or as he that lieth upon the top of a mast. ³⁵ They have stricken me, shalt thou say, and I was not sick; they have beaten me, and I felt it not: when shall I awake? I will seek it yet again.”***

ILLUSTRATION: (Bring out a snake in a glass box. Have the handler take the snake out of the box and see if anyone wants to handle it. If anyone wants to handle it, ask, if this person can handle it and the rest of you can't then why would we want to say it is alright to handle snakes when we know we would be placing the majority of you at risk?)

ILLUSTRATION: (Have everyone who has ever suffered from an addiction to stand; have everyone to sit down who did not start their addiction by experimenting with alcohol.)

No one ever purposes to become an alcoholic. Every alcoholic thought they knew where the lines were and were convinced they had enough will power to not infringe upon the limit. (Jason Cornett)

[If a little alcohol is good and a lot is bad, who decides where the line is? \(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE\)](#) If the individual decides where the line is what keeps their judgment from being impaired by the very thing they are making a decision about?

To condone the use of alcohol is to give Satan a senseless opportunity! Ephesians 4:24 (NKJV) ***“Do not give place to the devil.”*** The individual who refuses to have anything to do with such a dangerous taskmaster is wise indeed. Thomas Fuller said, *“A drinker has a hole under his nose that all his money runs into.”*

As we watch and pray for the return of Jesus, our senses should be as sharp and clear as they can possibly be. Luke 21:34-36 (NKJV) ***“But take heed to yourselves, lest your hearts be weighed down with carousing, drunkenness, and cares of this life, and that Day come on you unexpectedly. ³⁵“For it will come as a snare on all those who dwell on the face of the whole earth. ³⁶“Watch therefore, and pray always that you may be counted worthy to escape all these things that will come to pass, and to stand before the Son of Man.”***

(END OF SERMON #2)

Proverbs 22:28 (NKJV) ***“Do not remove the ancient landmark Which your fathers have set.”***

Proverbs 23:10-11 (NKJV) ***“Do not remove the ancient landmark, Nor enter the fields of the fatherless; ¹¹ For their Redeemer is mighty; He will plead their cause against you.”***

Hosea 5:10 (NKJV) ***“The princes of Judah are like those who remove a landmark; I will pour out my wrath on them like water.”***

Let’s assume the Scripture was silent on this issue, look at the societal damage which is being brought upon us because of this great evil: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Retail sales of alcohol related beverages total nearly \$120 billion dollars per year in the U.S. (U.S. Department of Agriculture)
- The average American family spends nearly \$500.00 per year on alcohol. (U.S. Bureau of Labor)
- Alcohol related crashes kill someone in the U.S. every 22 minutes. Within every minute, one of 50 drivers on the road is drunk and every weekend night, one out of 10 is drunk. (While you have sat in this service this morning, 5 people have died in alcohol related crashes) (Alcoholics Victorious)

- According to the Center for Disease Control in Atlanta, there are 105,000 alcohol related deaths annually due to drunken drivers and alcohol related injuries and diseases. (AFA journal)
- Alcohol related accidents are the leading cause of deaths among young people. (Dallas Morning Times)
- The damage caused by alcohol impaired drivers is the same as if a Boeing 747 with over 500 passengers crashed every eight days killing everyone. (Alcoholics Victorious) (If 46 Boeing 747's were crashing annually in the U.S. killing all 500 passengers aboard each plane, how many of you would want to go out to Hobby airport this afternoon and board one?)
- Drunk drivers are responsible for 1/2 of fatal highway injuries. (Alcoholics Victorious)
- An estimated 23,200 annual murders can be directly attributed to alcohol. (Newsweek)
- Of all murders, alcohol was involved in at least 34% of cases. (Alcoholics Victorious)
- More than 1/2 of rapists had been drinking. (Alcoholics Victorious)
- Mothers convicted of child abuse are 3 times more likely to be alcoholics - Fathers 10 times more likely. (Alcoholics Victorious)
- More than half of all confirmed abuse reports and 75% of child deaths involve drug or alcohol abuse on the part of the parents. (Time)
- Up to 36% of suicide victims were drinking just before ending their lives. (Prodigy Services Co.)
- Heavy drinking is involved in 60% of violent crimes, 36% of suicides, and 80% of fire and drowning accidents. (Alcoholics Victorious)
- The suicide rate of alcoholics is 30 times that of the general population. (AFA journal)
- The annual economic cost of alcohol abuse has risen to a projected \$186 billion. (Alcohol & Health - U.S. dept. of H.H.S.)
- 2.9% of 1,000 live births have fetal alcohol syndrome. (Alcoholics Victorious)
- It is costing one half billion dollars per year to treat fetal alcohol syndrome. (Alcoholics Victorious)
- It is estimated that 375,000 babies born each year are exposed to alcohol or illicit drugs parentally. (Alcoholics Victorious)
- The cost of government to prepare drug and alcohol babies to enter kindergarten has reached more than \$15 billion per year. (Reader's Digest)
- One baby with Fetal Alcohol Syndrome will cost \$405,000 in direct special services from birth to 65 years. (San Diego County Dept. of Health Services)

The consumption of alcohol has become a national crisis, tearing at the moral fabric of our nation. Thomas Fuller said, *“Wine hath drowned more men than the sea.”*

Christians cannot meet their moral responsibilities by a posture of neutrality about alcohol. The problem is not merely economic, cultural, or social. In the final analysis, the use of alcohol is a spiritual problem.

Alcoholism is a sin; it is not a sickness or a disease! If it is a sickness or disease it is the only disease known to man that you must continually acquire something to keep it!

Alcoholic beverages should have no place in the life of the Christian. Let there be no doubt about where Christian Temple and this Pastor stands on this very important issue, we declare unequivocally - our conviction, that total abstinence from alcoholic beverages is the only acceptable way of life for the Christian. We call upon every member and adherent in this church to teach by word and example a life-style that totally abstains from the consumption of alcoholic beverages.

(PLAY VIDEO OF LEE WILLIAMS)

II. THE CHRISTIAN AND ABORTION **Genesis 1:26-30 (NKJV)** *“Then God said, “Let Us make man in Our image, according to Our likeness; let them have dominion over the fish of the sea, over the birds of the air, and over the cattle, over all the earth and over every creeping thing that creeps on the earth.”*²⁷*So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them.*²⁸*Then God blessed them, and God said to them, “Be fruitful and multiply; fill the earth and subdue it; have dominion over the fish of the sea, over the birds of the air, and over every living thing that moves on the earth.”*²⁹*And God said, “See, I have given you every herb that yields seed which is on the face of all the earth, and every tree whose fruit yields seed; to you it shall be for food.”*³⁰*“Also, to every beast of the earth, to every bird of the air, and to everything that creeps on the earth, in which there is life, I have given every green herb for food”; and it was so.”*

Genesis 2:15-18 (NKJV) *“Then the LORD God took the man and put him in the garden of Eden to tend and keep it.”*¹⁶*And the LORD God commanded the man, saying, “Of every tree of the garden you may freely eat;”*¹⁷*“but of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil you shall not eat, for in the day that you eat of it you shall surely die.”*¹⁸*And the LORD God said, “It is not good that man should be alone; I will make him a helper comparable to him.”*

Genesis 2:21-24 (NKJV) *“The LORD God caused a deep sleep to fall on Adam, and he slept; and He took one of his ribs, and closed up the flesh in its place.*

²²Then the rib which the LORD God had taken from man He made into a woman, and He brought her to the man. ²³And Adam said: “This is now bone of my bones And flesh of my flesh; She shall be called Woman, Because she was taken out of Man.” ²⁴Therefore a man shall leave his father and mother and be joined to his wife, and they shall become one flesh. ²⁵And they were both naked, the man and his wife, and were not ashamed.”

Genesis 4:1-2 (NKJV) *“Adam knew Eve his wife, and she conceived and bore Cain, and said, “I have acquired a man from the LORD.” ²Then she bore again, this time his brother Abel. Now Abel was a keeper of sheep, but Cain was a tiller of the ground.”*

Exodus 20:13 (NKJV) *“Thou shalt not kill.”*

I am not sure how the term "Pro-Choice" became part of the lexicon as a euphemism for "Pro-Abortion" but I will not be using the term "Pro-Choice" during this sermon, I will be using the term "Pro-Abortion" to refer to those who embrace murdering unborn babies.

Some people assume everyone in the Democratic Party is Pro-Abortion, which is as inaccurate as to declare that everyone in the Republican Party is Pro-Life! Whether you are a Democrat, Republican, Independent, or other, it is a misnomer to declare yourself to be a Christian and support a Pro-Abortion candidate. It is my opinion that the most important consideration a Christian should evaluate when deciding who to vote for is where they stand on this very important issue.

In order to understand our subject matter, we must first come to understand:
(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- The miracle of life...
- The Value of life...
- The frailty of life...
- The brevity of life...

THE MIRACLE OF LIFE

The method of the creation of man in and of itself makes us aware that a human being is the crowning creation of God, and no man or woman has the right to make decisions about another's right to live! In all other instances of creation God spoke each thing into existence, but with man he *“formed”* him from *“the dust of the*

ground.” In the creation of the woman God caused a **“deep sleep”** to come upon Adam and he surgically removed a rib and built a woman around Adam’s rib. (Now you know why a man goes to sleep in an instant – All that is needed is a recliner and a remote control)

Because of the level of involvement which God had in the creation of man, we know that humans are the most important creation of God. Just like Adam and Eve, **each person is specifically and intentionally engineered with their own:**
(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Purpose...
- Physical appearance...
- Personality...
- Fingerprints...
- DNA...

Psalms 139:13-16 (NKJV) **“You formed my inward parts; You covered me in my mother’s womb. ¹⁴ I will praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made; Marvelous are Your works, And that my soul knows very well. ¹⁵ My frame was not hidden from You, When I was made in secret, And skillfully wrought in the lowest parts of the earth. ¹⁶ Your eyes saw my substance, being yet unformed. And in Your book they all were written, The days fashioned for me, When as yet there were none of them.”**

If God has formed each of us in such an intentional manner, how is it that some folks think the choice of another human being having the privilege of living on this earth; knowing God; accomplishing His purpose; and inheriting eternal life; is up to the woman in whose womb a child has been formed, or a sperm donor who wants benefits without responsibility?

I am all about freedom and individual liberties but my rights end where yours begin, and your rights end where mine begin. Life is not just precious, it is Divine! I am not even for abortion in cases where the mother’s life is in danger. Who has the authority to decide that one life can be traded for another? Besides, who say’s God cannot perform a miracle?

Who among us operates at such a high level that we have the power to choose who lives and who dies? Barak Obama was right to respond to the question about abortion with the answer, *“That is above my pay grade.”* I understand that he was attempting to soften the fact that he is strongly pro-abortion, which really should

be termed anti-life! He should have been pressed on the issue. The fact is that [the power to determine who lives and dies is “above the pay grade” of:](#) **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- All world leaders...
- The Supreme Court...
- All politicians...
- All religious leaders...
- All voters...
- All human beings...

God alone should be in charge of who lives and who dies!

God not only purposefully created Adam and Eve; with the same attention to detail, He has created every person who has been conceived from then till now; whether they had the opportunity to be born or not!

The plan of the ages did not just include a world for Adam and Eve; it included procreation and the filling up of the earth! [Genesis 1:28 \(KJV\)](#) ***“God said unto them, Be fruitful, and multiply, and replenish the earth.”*** Adam and Eve received a direct commandment from the Lord to populate the earth, and who among us has the authority to rescind it?

In order to fully understand why abortion is such a deplorable sin in the eyes of the Lord, I want to look closely at the process of reproduction. Reproduction, at any level, requires a process. In order for a child to be born the sperm of a man and the egg of a woman must come together, which if studied in depth is nothing short of a miracle in and of itself. The composition of sperm is such that only a minuscule part of it consists of a viable, life producing capability, and even then it must connect with the right egg of the woman in order to create a pregnancy. To make this short, it is a scientific fact that the chances of the sperm with my name on it, actually becoming me is one in twelve billion. There are only six billion people on the earth! Not very good odds! If you factor in two generations the chances that my Grandfathers sperm will become my Dad and that my Dad’s sperm will become me is 144 quintillion, which is 144 with eighteen zeroes behind it!

Beyond the initial act of intimacy between a man and a woman, it takes nine months for the process of reproduction to result in the birth of a baby. Reproduction is a process initiated by the Lord. [We see the process of reproduction in:](#) **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- The fish of the sea...
- The fowls of the air...
- The beast of the field...
- Plant life and vegetation...
- The human family...

I am going to quote [Charles R. Betticelli](#), Professor of Biology and Director of Mathematics at Newton College extensively in the following material: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Reproduction and pro-creation is, and always has been, the process through which God has moved His plans and programs forward on the earth... The promise is Gods, the process is ours! Dr. Betticelli say's; *"Reproduction is the process by which human beings, animals, and plants create more of their own kind. The survival of all species of living things depends on reproduction. If any species stopped reproducing, it would disappear when its present members died off."*
- The process of the fertilization of the organism through chromosomes is where the DNA or genetic code of the organism begins to take shape... Dr Betticelli said, *"The way a new organism develops after fertilization depends on chemical information in tiny structures called chromosomes. Each cell of the organism contains chromosomes."*
- The DNA of the organism will eventually dictate:
 - 1) What the baby will look like, hair color, eye color, etc...
 - 2) What the Baby's IQ will be...
 - 3) What kind of personality the baby will have...
 - 4) What kind of gifts and abilities the baby will possess...
- The human family was intended to be developed through a husband and wife who love each other and are committed to each other for life... Dr. Betticelli said, *"Human reproduction differs from reproduction in animals and plants because it involves more than just a biological (life) process. Among human beings, sex and reproduction involve love and other deep feelings."* The husband and wife are to raise children whom they love, and in turn the children will grow up healthy and do the same thing.
- Life does not begin at birth; it begins long before conception... Dr. Betticelli said, *"During the first two months of pregnancy the developing organism is called an embryo. Its development is programmed by the chemical information in the chromosomes from both the egg and the sperm. Within the first day after fertilization, the egg begins to divide. By the end of the*

first week, it has developed into a hollow ball of more than one hundred cells. During the second week, part of this ball becomes implanted (set) in the lining of the uterus.” The argument about abortion seems to center around when life begins. Let's look at what the Word of God has to say about it. [Psalm 139:13-18](#) (CEV) ***"You are the one who put me together inside my mother's body, 14 and I praise you because of the wonderful way you created me. Everything you do is marvelous! Of this I have no doubt. 15 Nothing about me is hidden from you! I was secretly woven together deep in the earth below, 16 but with your own eyes you saw my body being formed. Even before I was born, you had written in your book everything I would do. 17 Your thoughts are far beyond my understanding, much more than I could ever imagine. 18 I try to count your thoughts, but they outnumber the grains of sand on the beach. And when I awake, I will find you nearby."***

- [When a woman is pregnant, she is not carrying a fetus; she is carrying a baby...](#) Dr. Betticelli said, “One of the first steps in development after implantation is the formation of a structure called the placenta. The placenta is a disk-shaped organ of tissues and blood vessels that is attached to the lining of the uterus. The umbilical cord connects the embryo and the placenta. The umbilical cord and placenta are a "life line" that carries oxygen and nourishment from the mother to the developing child. They also carry carbon dioxide and other waste back to the mother. The embryo begins to look like a human being after about five weeks. After about two months nearly all the internal organs have formed, and the growing organism is called a fetus. After about three months the fetus looks very much like a human baby.” Because this society has been duped into believing, from conception to delivery, that which has been conceived is a fetus, we are comfortable with aborting the fetus or doing something to miscarry it. If the abortion just involves a fetus, then we are dealing with a thing; it is a baby; it is a human being! This is why the abortionists never refer to that which they are aborting, as a baby. Dr. Betticelli tells us that for the first two months the "organism" is "called an embryo." After two months the "organism" is "called a fetus." Webster defines these three words in the following ways:

- 1) Organism: “A complex structure of interdependent and subordinate elements whose relations and properties are largely determined by their function in the whole.”
- 2) Embryo: “A vertebrate (something having a spinal column) at any stage of development prior to birth or hatching; something as yet undeveloped; a beginning or undeveloped state of something.”

- 3) Fetus: *“An unborn or un-hatched vertebrate especially after attaining the basic structural plan of its kind; specifically: a developing human from usually three months after conception to birth.”*

When we begin to realize it is a baby rather than a fetus, the care for that child immediately raises to a different level of importance. **(PLAY AMANDA CARDENAS VIDEO)**

Even if it were legal, most mothers and fathers who abort a baby would not give birth to the child then take a butcher knife and kill it! Abortion is at least as cruel as killing a new born baby! If you have ever participated in an abortion, whether you are a man or a lady, we intend to help you through this process before this series comes to a conclusion.

THE VALUE OF LIFE

Why is abortion wrong?

(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- It violates one of the Ten Commandments which have to do with the sanctity of life...
- It terminates the plan of God for the life of a human being...
- It causes the course of the world to be altered because the baby which was aborted had a calling of God to fulfill in the earth...
- The act of abortion makes it much easier to terminate the plan of God in other areas of our life as well...

This culture is coming apart at the seams because people have failed to use their heads for anything besides a hat rack! Anyone with enough intelligence to study the process a baby passes through in its nine month odyssey to earth will know that abortion is nothing less than the intentional murder of another human being! Someone said, *“Abortion stops a beating heart.”* Abortion certainly stops a beating heart but more importantly it murders a human being and robs the earth of the potential which that human being possessed!

The Central Illinois chapter of Right to Life gives the following statistics for the reasons women choose to have an abortion: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- 95% - A means of birth control...
- 3% - Mother's health is in danger...
- 1% - The baby is believed to have health issues...

These statistics are broken down even further in a study conducted in 27 countries: (The Alan Guttmacher Institute Online) **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- 25.5% - Say they want to postpone child bearing...
- 21.3% - Say they cannot afford a baby...
- 14.1% - Say they are having relationship problems or their partner does not want the pregnancy...
- 12.2% - Say they are too young or their parents or others object to the pregnancy...
- 10.8% - Say a child would disrupt their education or interfere with a job...
- 7.9% - Say they do not want more children...
- 3.3% - Say the fetus is at risk...
- 2.8% - Say the mother's health is at risk...
- 2.1% - Give other reasons...

75% of all abortions performed in the United States of America are performed on women between the ages of 13 and 30! (Guttmacher Institute – “Trends in the Characteristics of Women Obtaining Abortions 1974-2004”)

Only one half of one percent of abortions are performed on women who have been raped or have been the victim of incest. (National Right to Life – “Why Do Women Have Abortions?”)

There is an old joke that has a man on a roof during a flood and a guy in a canoe came by and offered a ride, the stranded man said, *“No thank you, I’ve prayed and God is going to rescue me.”* The flood water rose to the point the man was standing knee deep in water and a policeman in a motorized rescue raft came by and offered the stranded man a ride to safety, *“No”* he said, *“I’ve prayed and God is going to rescue me.”* After a while the flood water was up to the stranded man’s neck and a coast guard helicopter hovered overhead, encouraging the man to take the lifeline they were making available to him, again he said, *“No thank you, I’ve prayed and God is going to rescue me.”* Twenty minutes later the stranded man was standing at the Pearly Gates asking God why He did not come to his rescue. God said, *“I sent a canoe, a boat and a helicopter, what more could you want?”*

I am afraid this culture is going to stand before God asking why he did not send a cure for cancer, aids, disease and poverty and God is going to say, *“I did but you aborted the people who were capable of solving the problem!”*

This culture reminds me of what the Bible has to say about the culture in Noah’s day! [Genesis 6:5-8](#) (NKJV) *“Then the LORD saw that the wickedness of man was great in the earth, and that every intent of the thoughts of his heart was only evil continually. ⁶And the LORD was sorry that He had made man on the earth, and He was grieved in His heart. ⁷So the LORD said, “I will destroy man whom I have created from the face of the earth, both man and beast, creeping thing and birds of the air, for I am sorry that I have made them.” ⁸But Noah found grace in the eyes of the LORD.”* [Proverbs 6:12-15](#) (NKJV) *“A worthless person, a wicked man, Walks with a perverse mouth; ¹³He winks with his eyes, He shuffles his feet, He points with his fingers; ¹⁴Perversity is in his heart, He devises evil continually, He sows discord. ¹⁵Therefore his calamity shall come suddenly; Suddenly he shall be broken without remedy.”* The result is a culture teetering on the brink of collapse! [Proverbs 14:34](#) (NKJV) *“Righteousness exalts a nation, But sin is a reproach to any people.”*

THE FRAILITY OF LIFE

(PLAY ROSSI DAWNS VIDEO)

Roe versus Wade has been responsible for the death of forty six million babies since 1973! [Think about the following annual abortion statistics:](#) **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- [Less than 9 weeks – 752,700 per year...](#)
- [9-10 weeks – 263,900 per year...](#)
- [11-12 weeks – 132,600 per year...](#)
- [13-15 weeks – 80,600 per year...](#)
- [16-20 weeks – 55,900 per year ...](#)
- [21weeks or more – 19,500 per year...](#)

Think of that, forty six million Americans killed in the last thirty six years! That is 3,500 dead, every day for the last 36 years, and we have politicians and preachers who cannot decide if it is appropriate? This is the equivalent of seven Boeing 747’s crashing every day for the last thirty six years killing everyone aboard! In that scenario, anyone want to go flying?

While I am not minimizing the sacrifice of the men and women who have given their lives in warfare defending our country; all life is valuable; Americans have

been their own worst enemy killing more of their own, than all of our enemies combined have killed!

Americans do not have the stomach to watch as a few thousand military people are killed in Iraq, while attempting to liberate a country of people who have never known freedom in their recent history. Yet, we have empowered the medical profession, who are sworn to preserve life at all cost, to exterminate the lives of those who cannot speak for themselves!

If we go beyond American statistics to consider the statistics around the world, more than forty six million babies are being aborted every year! That is one hundred twenty six thousand every day! (Center for Bioethical Reform)

The first child legally aborted in this country would now be thirty six years old and in the prime of its wage earning potential. That child, along with forty six million others like it have been murdered which means that **the retirees will soon outnumber the wage earners!** **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)**

The next generation will be forced to care for or eliminate their elderly parents because the government will not have the revenue necessary to take care of them. If I do not miss my guess by the time the next generation is saddled with the responsibility of caring for their elderly relatives, abortion will not only be in vogue, but euthanasia will be viewed as a way of dealing with the problem of the elderly!

The population of America is growing older faster than it is replenishing itself. The projections of an aging culture being circulated from the United States Government are staggering: **The number of persons aged sixty five years is expected to increase from approximately thirty five million in 2000 to an estimated seventy one million in 2030!** **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)**

The number of persons aged eighty years is expected to increase from nine million three hundred thousand in 2,000 to nineteen million five hundred thousand in 2,030.

Social Security is already in jeopardy of failing and the next twenty one years will add forty six million additional benefit seekers to an already overtaxed, underfunded, system! Wait a minute: What was that number? Forty six million?

Yes, forty six million, the exact same number of babies who have been aborted in the last thirty six years!

It does not take a mathematician to figure out a collapse is in the offing!

America will pay dearly for its sin! **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)** Solomon was right; *“Righteousness exalts a nation, but sin is a reproach to any people.”*

The government cannot pass enough laws to legislate morality because it cannot control the thought process of its citizens; but it can and should enact laws which protect life! Thomas Jefferson said, *“Democracy cannot control people who cannot control themselves.”*

The bottom line is this: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Abortion is nothing short of murder...
- The sixth commandment is, *“Thou shalt not kill”*...
- God will judge those who perform abortions; those who commit abortions; and those who defend those who do both...
- God always judges sin which is not confessed and repented of...
- America will be judged for the deaths of forty six million people who could not defend themselves... Genesis 4:1-13 (NKJV) *“Now Adam knew Eve his wife, and she conceived and bore Cain, and said, ‘I have acquired a man from the LORD.’”² Then she bore again, this time his brother Abel. Now Abel was a keeper of sheep, but Cain was a tiller of the ground.³ And in the process of time it came to pass that Cain brought an offering of the fruit of the ground to the LORD.⁴ Abel also brought of the firstborn of his flock and of their fat. And the LORD respected Abel and his offering,⁵ but He did not respect Cain and his offering. And Cain was very angry, and his countenance fell.⁶ So the LORD said to Cain, ‘Why are you angry? And why has your countenance fallen?’⁷ ‘If you do well, will you not be accepted? And if you do not do well, sin lies at the door. And its desire is for you, but you should rule over it.’”⁸ Now Cain talked with Abel his brother; and it came to pass, when they were in the field, that Cain rose up against Abel his brother and killed him.⁹ Then the LORD said to Cain, ‘Where is Abel your brother?’ He said, ‘I do not know. Am I my brother’s keeper?’”¹⁰ And He said, ‘What have you done? The voice of your brother’s blood cries out to Me from the ground.’”¹¹ “So now you are cursed from the earth, which has opened its mouth to receive your*

brother's blood from your hand. ¹²*“When you till the ground, it shall no longer yield its strength to you. A fugitive and a vagabond you shall be on the earth.”* ¹³*And Cain said to the LORD, “My punishment is greater than I can bear!”* ¹⁴*“Surely You have driven me out this day from the face of the ground; I shall be hidden from Your face; I shall be a fugitive and a vagabond on the earth, and it will happen that anyone who finds me will kill me.”* Do we really think God would judge so harshly a man who killed his sibling, and let slide 92 million parents (It takes two) who have killed their own defenseless children? Many have been the fathers who have shamed their sexual partner into taking care of the “Problem” by having an abortion! It is easy for a man to encourage a woman to have an abortion thinking the pain will be hers and not his. Sir, let me tell you, an abortion terminates your spiritual seed and when you intentionally do such a thing, you will be held at least as responsible as the lady who gave in to your selfish, egotistical, thoughtless demands! Abortion is designed to be a cover for irresponsible adults who want to sow their wild oats and pray for crop-failure. It is a way for adults to act irresponsibly with regard to their sexuality, creating a cover for fornication; adultery; incest; rape; etc...

Have we become so morally anemic that we have come to believe God will allow a government to escape His judgment, who does not so much as raise a voice of caution, while its citizens perpetrate the greatest holocaust the world has ever known? Are we so naive to the Holiness of God that we believe God will look the other way while this government aids and abets its own citizens in a murdering binge like the world has never known? The blood of forty six million babies is calling up from the ground for God to avenge their untimely and senseless deaths! America makes Adolph Hitler look like an amateur as it has outdistanced his murdering spree by seven and one half times!

THE BREVITY OF LIFE

Life at its best is much too brief. [Job 14:1-5](#) (NKJV) *“Man who is born of woman Is of few days and full of trouble. He comes forth like a flower and fades away; He flees like a shadow and does not continue.”* ³*And do You open Your eyes on such a one, And bring me to judgment with Yourself?* ⁴*Who can bring a clean thing out of an unclean? No one!* ⁵*Since his days are determined, The number of his months is with You; You have appointed his limits, so that he cannot pass.”* Psalms 39:4-6 (NKJV) *“LORD, make me to know my end, And what is the measure of my days, That I may know how frail I am.”* ⁵*Indeed, You have made my days as*

*handbreadths, And my age is as nothing before You; Certainly every man at his best state is but vapor. Selah*⁶ *Surely every man walks about like a shadow; Surely they busy themselves in vain; He heaps up riches, And does not know who will gather them.* James 4:13-15 (NKJV) *“Come now, you who say, “Today or tomorrow we will go to such and such a city, spend a year there, buy and sell, and make a profit”;¹⁴ whereas you do not know what will happen tomorrow. For what is your life? It is even a vapor that appears for a little time and then vanishes away.¹⁵ Instead you ought to say, “If the Lord wills, we shall live and do this or that.”*

If we live 80 years we only have: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME AND THEN LEAVE ALL OF THEM ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)**

- 2,436,489,000 Seconds...
- 40,608,000 Minutes...
- 678,800 Hours...
- 29,200 Days...
- 4,160 Weeks...
- 960 months...
- 8 Decades...
- .08 Centuries...

MSNBC reported on January 16, 2007, sixteen months after being rescued as a frozen embryo from a hospital in New Orleans which was flooded by Hurricane Katrina, Noah Benton Markham was born. (MSNBC “Baby is born from embryo rescued from Katrina.) Think of this, the frozen embryo survived the freezer and the flood to become a human being! While in a frozen state, the embryo contained Noah’s; skin color; hair color; eye color; physical features; personality; and DNA. Life begins before conception and if given a chance no matter how young or old, will add value to the world. Only God has the right to initiate or end life!

One thing is for sure; a culture which feels comfortable murdering forty six million babies will eventually euthanize its senior adults! Life is too precious and brief to allow the government, the culture, a doctor, a set of misguided parents; or the adult children of a senior citizen to cut it any shorter!

(ANNA LEIGH McINTOSH VIDEO)

CONCLUSION:

If you have participated in an abortion at any time there is forgiveness for you.
What must one do to be forgiven of such a hideous sin? **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Acknowledge that the abortion was a sin against God; a sin against your own body; a sin against your baby; and a sin against the human race...
- Repent before the Lord and allow His forgiveness to wash away every bit of guilt, remorse, and condemnation...
- Name the child which you aborted...
- Write the baby which you have aborted a letter of apology... (In the letter let the baby know you will meet them in Heaven)
- Read aloud the letter which you have written...
- Destroy the letter...
- Forgive yourself because God has...

(PLAY U-TUBE VIDEO OF “A BABY’S PRAYER”)

III. THE CHRISTIAN AND HOMOSEXUALITY

Leviticus 18:22 (NKJV) “You shall not lie with a male as with a woman. It is an abomination.”

Leviticus 20:13 (NKJV) “If a man lies with a male as he lies with a woman, both of them have committed an abomination. They shall surely be put to death. Their blood shall be upon them.”

1 Corinthians 6:9-10 (NKJV) “Do you not know that the unrighteous will not inherit the kingdom of God? Do not be deceived. Neither fornicators, nor idolaters, nor adulterers, nor homosexuals, nor sodomites,¹⁰ nor thieves, nor covetous, nor drunkards, nor revilers, nor extortioners will inherit the kingdom of God.”

Romans 1:18-32 (NKJV) “For the wrath of God is revealed from heaven against all ungodliness and unrighteousness of men, who suppress the truth in unrighteousness,¹⁹ because what may be known of God is manifest in them, for God has shown it to them. ²⁰For since the creation of the world His invisible attributes are clearly seen, being understood by the things that are made, even His eternal power and Godhead, so that they are without excuse, ²¹because, although they knew God, they did not glorify Him as God, nor were thankful, but became futile in their thoughts, and their foolish hearts were darkened. ²²Professing to be wise, they became fools, ²³and changed the glory of the

incorruptible God into an image made like corruptible man—and birds and four-footed animals and creeping things. ²⁴Therefore God also gave them up to uncleanness, in the lusts of their hearts, to dishonor their bodies among themselves, ²⁵who exchanged the truth of God for the lie, and worshiped and served the creature rather than the Creator, who is blessed forever. Amen. ²⁶For this reason God gave them up to vile passions. For even their women exchanged the natural use for what is against nature. ²⁷Likewise also the men, leaving the natural use of the woman, burned in their lust for one another, men with men committing what is shameful, and receiving in themselves the penalty of their error which was due. ²⁸And even as they did not like to retain God in their knowledge, God gave them over to a debased mind, to do those things which are not fitting; ²⁹being filled with all unrighteousness, sexual immorality, wickedness, covetousness, maliciousness; full of envy, murder, strife, deceit, evil-mindedness; they are whisperers, ³⁰backbiters, haters of God, violent, proud, boasters, inventors of evil things, disobedient to parents, ³¹undiscerning, untrustworthy, unloving, unforgiving, unmerciful; ³²who, knowing the righteous judgment of God, that those who practice such things are deserving of death, not only do the same but also approve of those who practice them.”

1 Timothy 1:9-10 (NKJV) *“The law is not made for a righteous person, but for the lawless and insubordinate, for the ungodly and for sinners, for the unholy and profane, for murderers of fathers and murderers of mothers, for manslayers, ¹⁰for fornicators, for sodomites, for kidnappers, for liars, for perjurers, and if there is any other thing that is contrary to sound doctrine.”*

I am not sure how the term "Gay" become part of the lexicon as a euphemism for homosexual behavior because it is far from a gay choice for life. During this sermon I will not be referring to those who engage in same sex relationships as being “Gay,” I will be referring to them as “Homosexuals.” I am not doing this in an attempt to be hateful; I just refuse to refer to something with a term that absolutely does not describe the activity.

The book of Romans is a letter which the Apostle Paul wrote to the Christians who were in Rome. The Roman culture was much like ours with sinful practices being endorsed and Holy living being mocked and ridiculed. It is in this context that Paul encourages Holiness and addresses the sin of homosexuality in a very pointed way. He begins his letter by taking on a multitude of sins which have proven very costly to the human race, one of which is the sin of homosexuality.

I want us to take a few minutes and place this passage of Scripture into proper perspective. Paul shares the following insights with the Romans: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- In verses eighteen thru twenty it is revealed that the wrath of God will be visited upon the unrighteousness of man... Mankind is not ignorant of the expectations of God but rather than following Godly principles this culture has couched righteousness in unrighteousness. This sinful practice will be visited upon the human race, and the only path of escape is repentance and a change of direction.
- Verses twenty one thru twenty three employs some very strong language with regard to idol worship... One of the Ten Commandments still read ***“You shall have no other God’s before me.”*** God is a jealous God and He will not permit His creation to worship anything other than Himself and escape the judgment that comes with wrongly directed worship.
- Verses twenty four and twenty five take a turn toward more specific details of what God is attempting to tell the Roman Christians... In these verses we see a picture of the culture in which we are presently functioning; because of the sinful, unrepentant condition of the hearts of the people God decides to allow man to follow his own devices. The picture here is that of God washing His hands of these people and walking away, leaving them to destroy to self-destruct. When this happens, man ***“Worships the creature rather than the creator.”*** This culture is sex crazed; everywhere we look sex is presented as something to be pursued; sex sells and sells big time. The culture has been inundated with free sex and a philosophy of; do it; do it often; do it with anyone who is available; do it irrespective of gender; and if you cannot find anyone to do it with, do it by yourself! This culture is actively worshipping at the altar of sex and sinful pleasure and the church is either participating or being silent! Again, God said ***“You shall have no other God’s before me.”*** Rest assured, this pleasure worshipping culture will be judged for its sin!
- Verses twenty six and twenty seven, takes on the sin of homosexuality... These verses reveal such sin to be a result of unbridled lust finding its ultimate destination. When lust goes unbridled in one’s life it can never find a point of complete satisfaction. Unbridled lust eventually needs an outlet which is not natural. According to the writer of Romans, homosexuality is a sin against nature itself. It is not a natural thing, for a woman to have sex with another woman; or a man to have sex with another man. Even the animal kingdom knows better than that! The writer here also lets us know, when a person involves themselves in this kind of activity, eventually God

will turn one over to their unrestrained lust to do that which is unnatural. When this happens, the participants in such an activity will reap the consequences of their own actions. I realize there are many ways one can contract aids; but a person involved in a homosexual lifestyle is two times (Center for Disease Control, 2007) more likely to contract the disease than a heterosexual person! In fact, when donating blood if the box is checked that a person has had male on male sex, it is against the law to donate blood!

- **Verses twenty nine thru thirty one tells us that those who practice this lifestyle open themselves up to twenty three additional sinful practices...:**
“...unrighteousness, sexual immorality, wickedness, covetousness, maliciousness; full of envy, murder, strife, deceit, evil-mindedness; they are whisperers, ³⁰backbiters, haters of God, violent, proud, boasters, inventors of evil things, disobedient to parents, ³¹undiscerning, untrustworthy, unloving, unforgiving, unmerciful.” This explains why the modern day homosexual agenda is filled with venom toward anyone who dares to speak out against such a lifestyle. It seems that very few people who practice a homosexual lifestyle are capable of allowing the sin to be spoken of without internalizing it and making it personal. Just because I choose to speak out against alcoholism does not mean I do not respect or care for the alcoholic. Preaching this sermon does not mean I hate homosexuals, I am merely saying this is not an acceptable lifestyle according to natural law and the law of God.
- **In verse thirty two, Paul lets us know, those who practice such a lifestyle are deserving of death...** He also tells us, those who approve such a lifestyle are worthy of the same penalty. What does he mean by ***“those who approve them”***? Those who accept this kind of a lifestyle as normal; those who encourage others to follow such a pattern; those who push legislation to legalize it; those who vote for those who vote to legalize it; those who watch it in the privacy of their own bedroom; those who watch it at the theatre or bring it into their home! Before anyone cocks a gun to carry out the punishment of God upon those who practice a homosexual lifestyle, let me remind us, life is precious in the sight of God and God alone has the authority to give or take life; judgment is not ours, it is Gods; we must love the homosexual but we are to stand firmly against the lifestyle which they have chosen to embrace.

Before any of us get rocks out to stone the homosexuals, let me remind us, the same Bible which pronounces judgment upon the sin of the homosexual, pronounces judgment upon the sin of the fornicator; the adulterer; the

whoremonger; the thief; the liar; and the gossip! Need I say more? The Bible say's ***"The soul that sins shall surely die."*** Death is the penalty for all sin!

David Kinnaman, in his book *Un-Christian* says this: *"It is one thing to be against homosexuality, to affirm that the Bible rejects the practice of same-sex lifestyles, but it is another to be against homosexuals, to let your disagreement with their behavior spill out in your feelings and words toward them as people."*

Sin is sin! Are there degrees of sin? No! However, there are degrees of consequences; lying is just as bad as being an adulterer in the sight of God but the consequences are different. Cheating is just as bad as homosexuality but the consequences are different. While there are no degrees of sin, sexual sin carries a consequence which is not seen in any other sin. [1 Corinthians 6:15-20](#) (NKJV) ***"Do you not know that your bodies are members of Christ? Shall I then take the members of Christ and make them members of a harlot? Certainly not! ¹⁶Or do you not know that he who is joined to a harlot is one body with her? For "the two," He says, "shall become one flesh." ¹⁷But he who is joined to the Lord is one spirit with Him. ¹⁸Flee sexual immorality. Every sin that a man does is outside the body, but he who commits sexual immorality sins against his own body. ¹⁹Or do you not know that your body is the temple of the Holy Spirit who is in you, whom you have from God, and you are not your own? ²⁰For you were bought at a price; therefore glorify God in your body and in your spirit, which are God's."***

Some ill-informed Christians would say, God destroyed the city of Sodom and Gomorrah because of the sin of homosexuality. It is true that homosexuality is a sin, and God judged that very sin in the destruction of the city. But a little closer look at the reason for the demise of the city runs way deeper than any one sin. While the angels were in Lot's house, the men of the city beat on the door, wanting Lot to send the angels out so they could have sexual relations with them. Lot offers his two daughters to them, who happened to be virgins, but the men of the city wanted to have homosexual relations with two same sex strangers rather than having sex with two beautiful, pure, virgins of the opposite sex! Trust me, the sin of Sodom did not begin with Homosexuality, but it did end there. The cumulative sins of that culture incurred the fierce judgment of God!

I am afraid, we as a nation stand on the precipice of seeing a similar thing happen as a result of sin being allowed to run rampant and no one sounding an alarm against it! When God's prophets, priests, preachers, and people fail to sound the alarm, judgment is usually not far behind! The sin of America did not begin with

homosexuality but it will most certainly end there. (In October 2009 a world renowned preacher was interviewed on FOX and he was asked if he believed “*Homosexuality was a sin and would send a person to hell?*” His response was “*I do not believe it is Gods best!*” It not only is not Gods best, it is not from God at all!)

After very careful study, it is my opinion that **the sin of homosexuality is taking a huge toll on those caught in the web of its deceit: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- **Homosexuals average living twenty years less than their heterosexual counterparts...** (Oxford Journals – “Modeling the impact of HIV disease on morality in gay and bisexual men”)
- **On average cigarette smoking takes ten years off a person’s life.** (British Medical Journal – Morality in relation to smoking: 50 years’ observations on male British doctors.”) **Homosexuality shortens a person’s expected lifespan 200 percent more than does cigarette smoking...**
- **43% of homosexuals have had sex with 500 partners or more in their lifetime...** (Journal of Sex Research – “A comparative demographic and sexual profile of older homosexually active men.”)
- **28% of homosexuals have had sex with 1,000 or more partners in their life...** (Journal of Sex Research – “A comparative demographic and sexual profile of older homosexually active men.”)

The government and the public school systems are by-in-large teaching that there is nothing wrong with such a practice and anyone who refutes this rhetoric is a mean spirited radical who should be prosecuted for a hate crime. (My experience in Malvern AR with a school system that would not allow their students to take certain textbooks home because they did not want the parents of the students to discover what kind of curriculum was being taught)

I want to make this abundantly clear; as a minister of the Gospel I love people; people of all types; people of all shapes; people of all nationalities; people of all religious preferences; and people of all sexual orientations.

Everyone is welcome in this church; we will love you; pray for you; fellowship with you; and encourage you; but if you are a practicing sinner, and this goes for the sin of homosexuality as well, you cannot have membership in this church. We do not accept the lifestyle of a whoremonger any more than we accept the lifestyle of the homosexual; there is no place in the Kingdom of God for habitual sin! All

sex outside of a heterosexual marriage relationship is sin. That means gay sex, extramarital affairs, casual or recreational sex, and everything in between. If it is not between a man and a woman inside a marriage covenant, then it is sin.

This means the gay man sitting next to the girl who is sleeping with her boyfriend, whose father is involved in an extramarital affair are all disobeying God and therefore are in danger of hell as a result of their sin!

While we love and accept the sinner, we refuse to accept a sinful lifestyle as “normal” in the Kingdom of God, and this includes but is not limited to the sin of homosexuality. Homosexuality is not a normal way of life; it is perverted, deviant and devilish!

Young people, this is a sin which will take you much farther than you intended to go; it will keep you longer than you intended to stay; and it will cost far more than you intended to pay; flee this lifestyle at all cost!

Are people born as homosexuals? No! No one is born a homosexual any more than one is born a thief; a liar; a drunkard; a whoremonger; or a gossip! Most of the sin we involve ourselves in during the course of life is learned behavior! We develop habits by repeatedly doing what we know we should not do! Eventually bad behavior develops a habit; a habit turns into a lifestyle; a deviant lifestyle turns into bondage! [James 1:14-15](#) (NKJV) **“But each one is tempted *when he is drawn away by his own desires and enticed.* ¹⁵Then, when desire has conceived, it gives birth to sin; and sin, when it is full-grown, brings forth death.”**

There is absolutely no scientific evidence that one is born homosexual. The homosexual gene has yet to be discovered because there is no such thing! If people are not born homosexual, how, why and where do such tendencies come from?

I believe [the homosexual lifestyle is initiated in several ways:](#) **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- [Through the rejection or neglect of a father or mother figure in one’s life...](#)
It is my opinion that the escalation of the sin of homosexuality in our day can be tied to the divorce rate; couples living together outside of marriage; deadbeat dads; and worthless moms! In this scenario one often attempts to make others the mother or father one never had, or at least didn't get enough of. Such loneliness can also create a vacuum for sexual problems such as

addiction to pornography; sexual promiscuity; a complete shutdown of one's sexual feelings; and many other things which I do not care to discuss in mixed company. In the absence of real sources of love, one will attempt to bond to false sources. A lack of love tempts us to secure love out of the "false self" using "false sources." Rejection from others means that we received the following message: "I am unacceptable." This identity of unacceptability can come down upon us from our families, our peer groups and through people who are in authority over us. We accumulate labels and experiences that tell us we are not worthy of love. People sin against us by demeaning who we are, telling us we will never amount to anything, all the while cursing the purpose of God for our lives! When a person begins to accept such things as truth, they are susceptible to low self esteem, an unflattering opinion of God, chemical abuse, and sexual deviant behavior.

- **Through the overly dominant role of a father or mother...** Every child needs a father and a mother! Marriage should be between one man and one woman! A man and a woman should balance their roles properly and raise normal, well educated, socially adjusted, economically productive, heterosexual children! Oftentimes, when there is an overpowering father, the daughter will seek love in the arms of another woman because she is afraid to yield herself to a man. When there is a mother in the home who rules with a rod of iron, the son will seek a homosexual lifestyle because he has a skewed view of the role of a woman in the family. The design of Father God was and is for all human and animal life to be heterosexual and produce after its kind!
- **Through abuse or trauma in the formative years...** I want to preface my remarks here; we have incarcerated young men and women, who were just over the legal age for sexual activity because they behaved inappropriately with someone who was just under the legal age. While I am in no way approving such actions, those people do not need to be incarcerated; they need a brisk caning from their parents! We have convicted many persons who were innocent upon the word of a child, who was fed information by someone on a witch hunt! We have strained at a knat and swallowed a camel! On the other hand, anyone who abuses a child should never have the opportunity to reoffend! The long term effect of abuse in the formative years is far reaching and highly effective in keeping one from living up to their potential. Abuse involves a misuse of power. This can take many forms; emotional; physical; verbal; or sexual. In sexual abuse, an adult breaks into a child's world and destroys his or her innocence. I believe God has a special place reserved in Hell for adults who violate the innocence of a

child! The child's view of sex and intimacy becomes distorted and they often seek fulfillment in deviant ways.

- **Through pornography and intentional sexual deviant behavior...** Most homosexuals are living the way they are for the same reason people commit adultery; they have chosen to live this way! God can deliver us from anything but He will not deliver us from ourselves!

At the end of the day, while these things can perhaps explain why some people are the way they are; these things are no excuse for following such a lifestyle.

Statistics show that if a person was physically abused as a child there is a better than good chance they will grow up to be an abuser! That does not mean they must become abusive, they have a choice and many have chosen not to be an abuser! Just because one grew up in a broken home does not mean they must create a broken home of their own! Just because one's mother abandoned them does not mean they must become a serial rapist, or a mass murderer! Just because some of these things are present in our lives does not give one an excuse to be a homosexual!

Choose Jesus! Choose to live right! Choose holiness! Possess your vessel in sanctification and honor!

It is believed that as many as 10% of Americans are homosexual! (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE) The sins of this society will be visited upon the succeeding generations. The next generation will reap the negative consequences of abortion and homosexual activity. Roe Verses Wade has been responsible for the aborting of forty six million babies since 1973 all the while the homosexual agenda has become a priority.

As a result, pro-creation within these relationships is impossible! If the population of the United States of America is three hundred five million (According to the U. S. Census Bureau) and 10% are homosexual, this means that because of homosexuality, fifteen million American couples will not pro create! You add fifteen million couples not pro-creating, to forty six million abortions and what you soon conclude is that the population is growing older at a much faster rate than it is replenishing itself. The sinful pattern of the adults in the current social order, are without question being visited upon generations to come.

Whether one has been introduced or enticed into a homosexual situation through rejection or neglect; an overly dominant father or mother; abuse or trauma;

pornography or intentional sexual deviant behavior; I want you to know there is room at the cross and in this church for you!

If you have been tempted by; or involved in the sin of homosexuality and want deliverance and redemption you should: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Acknowledge your sinful behavior...
- Accept the forgiveness the Savior is offering...
- Accept the forgiveness this church is offering...
- Release the pain within, by forgiving others who have sinned against you...
- Forgive yourself for every sin you have ever committed...
- Let today be the first day of the rest of your life...